Erythropoietin Stimulating Agents:

Aranesp (Darbepoetin alfa), Procrit (Epoetin alfa), Epogen (Epoetin alfa), Retacrit (epoetin alfa-epbx)

Original Effective Date: 5/2/2022
Revision Date(s): 05/02/2022; 3/18/2023; 2/19/2024; 3/24/2025; 3/16/2026
Review Date: 3/16/2026
Policy type: Medical Necessity
Line of Business: All G.E.H.A Medical Plans

Authorizations are issued for 6 (six) months, unless the ordering physician requests a different timespan or the patients' unique circumstance or condition supports the medical necessity for a different authorization timeframe. Reauthorization requests are reviewed for efficacy, safety and tolerability.

Preference	Requires Prior Auth	Drug Name	HCPCS Code	Description
Preferred	Yes	**Retacrit**	**Q5106**	Injection, Epoetin alfa-epbx, biosimilar, (retacrit) (for non-esrd use), 1000 units
Preferred	Yes	**Aranesp**	**J0881**	Injection, Darbepoetin alfa, 1 microgram (non-esrd use)
Non-Preferred	Yes	**Epogen**	**J0885**	Injection, Epoetin alfa, (for non-esrd use), 1000 units
Non-Preferred	Yes	**Procrit**	**J0885**	Injection, Epoetin alfa, (for non-esrd use), 1000 units

- Members must have documentation of a contraindication, failure, or intolerance to any of the preferred agents prior to approval of a non-preferred product, when clinically appropriate.
- Preferred product requirements apply to new starts only.
- Step Therapy applies to all overlapping compendia supported indications/regimens.

Criteria applied to all requests:

- Hemoglobin values are obtained within 28 days of the date of administration; **AND**
- Iron stores must be adequate with a transferrin saturation (TSAT) ≥ 20% AND a ferritin ≥ 100 ng/mL within the last 120 days; **AND**
- Other causes of anemia (such as to folate deficiency, B-12 deficiency, iron deficiency, hemolysis, bleeding, bone marrow fibrosis etc.) must be ruled out